

March

4

1351

King U-Thong

Ramathibodhi I, crowned King U-Thong, became the ruler of a vast kingdom in the Chao Praya Valley, in present-day Thailand. During his reign, U-Thong formed alliances, expanded trade, created a legal system, and built a capital city.



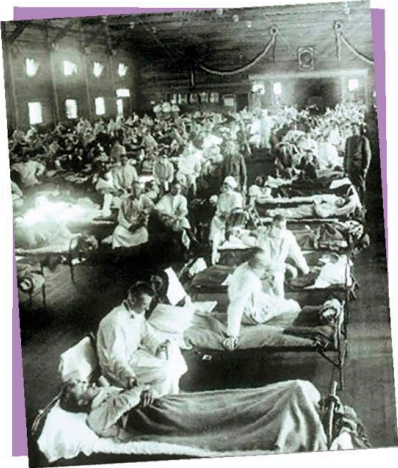
Born this day

1877 Garrett Morgan, Black American entrepreneur. Despite a limited education, he invented a breathing apparatus, discovered a way of straightening hair, and improved traffic signals.

1918

Spanish flu

The first recorded cases of Spanish flu were found in about 100 soldiers suffering similar cold-like symptoms at the US army base of Fort Riley in Kansas. This highly contagious disease claimed millions of lives worldwide.



2020

Tightrope stunt

When he walked on a tightrope over the Masaya volcano in Nicaragua, US daredevil Nik Wallenda became the first person to cross an active volcano. He wore a mask to avoid inhaling fumes during the nail-biting feat, shown live on television.



Also on this day

1789 The US Constitution went into effect as the supreme governing law of the USA.

1951 The first Asian Games were held in New Delhi, India, with 11 countries taking part.

1980 Nationalist leader Robert Mugabe won the elections in Zimbabwe and took charge as the country's first Black prime minister.